

Noise near the Freeport and airport: never studied?

ADPD's call for a study, tested against official noise maps and local research

THE CLAIM

“...yet to acknowledge that noise pollution is having an effect on the health of those who live near the Freeport...”

ADPD – The Green Party, Birżebbuġa, 26 May 2026

Said by deputy chairpersons Carmel Cacopardo and Melissa Bagley.

No health-outcome study found; noise levels have been mapped or measured.

VERDICT

LARGELY SUPPORTED

No health study found, but noise is mapped or measured.

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

0 of 5

ERA documents naming Freeport

Of five read: round 4 mapping, two action plans, annex, airport report.

≈9,700

People in modelled aircraft noise

At 55 dB Lden or more, 2016 (airport report). Exposure only, no health data.

5 of 5

Birżebbuġa points over 55 dBA

By day, University of Malta survey 2020–21; Freeport named as a main source.

98%

Residents calling noise a problem

477 questionnaires (2022 paper); self-reported, not clinical.

2014–15

Freeport-funded noise study

Reported by TVM; the report itself not seen.

FAIR TO SAY

Noise near both sites has been measured or mapped; a health study of residents is still missing.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ ERA: is the Freeport covered by any noise mapping?

☐ Malta Freeport Terminals: the 2014–15 report.

☐ Public Health: any health assessment of residents.